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Live prediction of player performances in tennis

Abstract

A computing system receives pre-match data for an upcoming match between a first player and a second player. The computing system generates, using one or more prediction models, one or more pre-match predictions based on the pre-match data. The computing system receives in-match data for the match currently in progress. The computing system generates, using the one or more prediction models, one or more live match predictions based on the in-match data.

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Background/Summary

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS (1) This application claims priority to U.S. Provisional Application Ser. No. 63/201,710, filed May 10, 2021, which is hereby incorporated by reference in its entirety.

FIELD OF THE DISCLOSURE

(1) The present disclosure generally relates to system and method for generating live prediction of player performance in tennis.

BACKGROUND

(2) While many professional sports leagues have varying amounts of sports analytics that drive performance discussion and what-if analyses, such fine-grained statistics is typically absent from tennis. In tennis, there are varying degrees of scoring, from as granular as the game level to as broad as the overall match level.

SUMMARY

(3) In some embodiments, a method is disclosed herein. A computing system receives pre-match data for an upcoming match between a first player and a second player. The pre-match data includes one or more of historical match data for the first player and the second player, player strength information for the first player and the second player, player style information for the first player and the second player, playing surface type, or weather conditions. The computing system generates, using one or more prediction models, one or more pre-match predictions based on the pre-match data. The computing system receives in-match data for the match currently in progress. The in-match data includes one or more of match-state information, match-statistics and features, momentum, the player strength information for the first player and the second player, the player style information for the first player and the second player, the playing surface type, or updated weather conditions. The computing system generates, using the one or more prediction models, one or more live match predictions based on the in-match data.

(4) In some embodiments, a non-transitory computer readable medium is disclosed herein. The non-transitory computer readable medium includes one or more sequences of instructions, which, when executed by a processor, causes a computing system to perform operations. The operations include receiving, by the computing system, pre-match data for a match between a first player and a second player. The pre-match data includes one or more of historical match data for the first player and the second player, player strength information for the first player and the second player, player style information for the first player and the second player, a playing surface type, or weather conditions. The operations further include generating, by the computing system using one or more prediction models, a pre-match prediction based on the pre-match data. The operations further include receiving, by the computing system, in-match data for the match currently in progress. The in-match data includes one or more of match-state information, match-statistics and features, momentum, the player strength information for the first player and the second player, the player style information for the first player and the second player, the playing surface type, or updated weather conditions. The operations further include generating, by the computing system using the one or more prediction models, a live match prediction based on the in-match data.

(5) In some embodiments, a system is disclosed herein. The system includes a processor and a memory. The memory has programming instructions stored thereon, which, when executed by the processor, causes the system to perform operations. The operations include receiving pre-match data for a match between a first player and a second player. The pre-match data includes one or more of historical match data for the first player and the second player, player strength information for the first player and the second player, player style information for the first player and the second player, a playing surface type, or weather conditions. The operations further include generating, using one or more prediction models, a pre-match prediction based on the pre-match data. The operations further include receiving in-match data for the match currently in progress. The in-match data includes one or more of match-state information, match-statistics and features, momentum, the player strength information for the first player and the second player, the player style information for the first player and the second player, the playing surface type, or updated

weather conditions. The operations further include generating, using the one or more prediction models, a live match prediction based on the in-match data.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

(1) So that the manner in which the above recited features of the present disclosure can be understood in detail, a more particular description of the disclosure, briefly summarized above, may be had by reference to embodiments, some of which are illustrated in the appended drawings. It is to be noted, however, that the appended drawings illustrated only typical embodiments of this disclosure and are therefore not to be considered limiting of its scope, for the disclosure may admit to other equally effective embodiments.

(2) FIG. 1 is a block diagram illustrating a computing environment, according to example embodiments.

(3) FIG. 2 is a block diagram illustrating prediction models, according to example embodiments.

(4) FIG. 3 illustrates an exemplary graphical user interface (GUI), according to example embodiments.

(5) FIG. 4 illustrates an exemplary graphical user interface (GUI), according to example embodiments.

(6) FIG. 5 illustrates an exemplary graphical user interface (GUI), according to example embodiments.

(7) FIG. 6A illustrates an exemplary graphical user interface (GUI), according to example embodiments.

(8) FIG. 6B illustrates an exemplary graphical user interface (GUI), according to example embodiments.

(9) FIG. 7A illustrates an exemplary graphical user interface (GUI), according to example embodiments.

(10) FIG. 7B illustrates an exemplary graphical user interface (GUI), according to example embodiments.

(11) FIG. 8 is a flow diagram illustrating a method of generating pre-match and in-match tennis predictions, according to example embodiments.

(12) FIG. 9A is an exemplary diagram illustrating a match state of a tennis game, according to example embodiments.

(13) FIG. 9B is an exemplary diagram illustrating a match state of a tennis game, according to example embodiments.

(14) FIG. 10A is a block diagram illustrating a computing device, according to example embodiments.

(15) FIG. 10B is a block diagram illustrating a computing device, according to example embodiments.

(16) To facilitate understanding, identical reference numerals have been used, where possible, to designate identical elements that are common to the figures. It is contemplated that elements disclosed in one embodiment may be beneficially utilized on other embodiments without specific recitation.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

(17) In sports like tennis, there are many different levels of scoring, which can provide an indication of performance at any point of time at varying scales. For example, in the short term, there is game-level scoring; in this mid-term, there is set-level scoring; and in the long-term, there is match-level scoring. Even though the multi-scale scoring mechanism may provide an indication of which player may be dominating in the short-term, mid-term, and long-term, such approach does

not take into consideration other important contextual features, such as player strength/style and court-type information. Additionally, the match-score typically only tells viewers what has happened in the game and cannot convey the importance of each point or simulate alternative outcomes in key moments.

(18) One or more techniques described herein provide an improvement over conventional techniques by providing a system that can provide predictions of a player winning a next-point, current game (and game score), current set (and set score), and winning the overall match after every logged event which captures the granular player specific and context specific information.

(19) In some embodiments, the one or more techniques described herein may not only provide granular and specific predictions, but also can leverage these predictions of “what-if” analyses, which may provide or generate alternative outcomes at every point (such as, for example, break points). The various predictions and what-if analyses make take in the current score or any possible input score query (or match-up of players). The input and output to the model may take the shape of any form, such as an interactive website/widget, chatbot or virtual assistant, speech recognizer, or the like. In some embodiments, the output can be text, visual, or an overlay on a broadcast (linear or over-the-top (OTT)).

(20) Additionally, one or more techniques provided herein may leverage the various predictions to create new tennis metrics, such as “clutch,” “plus/minus,” and “momentum.” The predictions and derived metrics may then be used to generate and rank insights which may be provided to end users.

(21) FIG. 1 is a block diagram illustrating a computing environment **100**, according to example embodiments. Computing environment **100** may include tracking system **102**, organization computing system **104**, and one or more client devices **108** communicating via network **105**.

(22) Network **105** may be of any suitable type, including individual connections via the Internet, such as cellular or Wi-Fi networks. In some embodiments, network **105** may connect terminals, services, and mobile devices using direct connections, such as radio frequency identification (RFID), near-field communication (NFC), Bluetooth™, low-energy Bluetooth™ (BLE), Wi-Fi™, ZigBee™, ambient backscatter communication (ABC) protocols, USB, WAN, or LAN. Because the information transmitted may be personal or confidential, security concerns may dictate one or more of these types of connection be encrypted or otherwise secured. In some embodiments, however, the information being transmitted may be less personal, and therefore, the network connections may be selected for convenience over security.

(23) Network **105** may include any type of computer networking arrangement used to exchange data or information. For example, network **105** may be the Internet, a private data network, virtual private network using a public network and/or other suitable connection(s) that enables components in computing environment **100** to send and receive information between the components of environment **100**.

(24) Tracking system **102** may be positioned in a venue **106**. For example, venue **106** may be configured to host a sporting event that includes one or more agents **112**. Tracking system **102** may be configured to record the motions of all agents (i.e., players) on the playing surface, as well as one or more other objects of relevance (e.g., ball, referees, etc.). In some embodiments, tracking system **102** may be an optically-based system using, for example, a plurality of fixed cameras. For example, a system of six stationary, calibrated cameras, which project the three-dimensional locations of players and the ball onto a two-dimensional overhead view of the court may be used. In some embodiments, tracking system **102** may be a radio-based system using, for example, radio frequency identification (RFID) tags worn by players or embedded in objects to be tracked. Generally, tracking system **102** may be configured to sample and record, at a high frame rate (e.g., 25 Hz). Tracking system **102** may be configured to store at least player identity and positional information (e.g., (x, y) position) for all agents and objects on the playing surface for each frame in a match file **110**.

(25) Match file **110** may be augmented with other event information corresponding to event data, such as, but not limited to, game event information (pass, made shot, turnover, etc.) and context information (current score, time remaining, etc.).

(26) Tracking system **102** may be configured to communicate with organization computing system **104** via network **105**. Organization computing system **104** may be configured to manage and analyze the data captured by tracking system **102**.

(27) Organization computing system **104** may include at least a web client application server **114**, a pre-processing agent **116**, a data store **118**, and one or more prediction models **122**. Each of pre-processing agent **116** and prediction models **122** may be comprised of one or more software modules. The one or more software modules may be collections of code or instructions stored on a media (e.g., memory of organization computing system **104**) that represent a series of machine instructions (e.g., program code) that implements one or more algorithmic steps. Such machine instructions may be the actual computer code the processor of organization computing system **104** interprets to implement the instructions or, alternatively, may be a higher level of coding of the instructions that is interpreted to obtain the actual computer code. The one or more software modules may also include one or more hardware components. One or more aspects of an example algorithm may be performed by the hardware components (e.g., circuitry) itself, rather as a result of the instructions.

(28) Data store **118** may be configured to store one or more match files **126**. Each match file **126** may include spatial event data and non-spatial event data. For example, spatial event data may correspond to raw data captured from a particular game or event by tracking system **102**. Non-spatial event data may correspond to one or more variables describing the events occurring in a particular match without associated spatial information. For example, non-spatial event data may correspond to each play-by-play or shot-by-shot event in a particular match. In some embodiments, non-spatial event data may be derived from spatial event data. For example, pre-processing agent **116** may be configured to parse the spatial event data to derive play-by-play or shot-by-shot information. In some embodiments, non-spatial event data may be derived independently from spatial event data. For example, an administrator or entity associated with organization computing system may analyze each match to generate such non-spatial event data. As such, for purposes of this application, event data may correspond to spatial event data and non-spatial event data.

(29) In some embodiments, each match file **126** may further include match state information. Match state information may include scoring data such as, but not limited to, game scores (e.g., 0, 15, 30, 40, deuce, advantage), set scores (e.g., 0-6 or tie-break to 7), and match scores (e.g., 0, 1, 2 or 0-3 in men's grand slams) at each point of a match. In some embodiments, each match file **126** may further include match-stats and features. Exemplary match-stats and features may include, but are not limited to, a number of aces, winners, forced errors, first/second serve percentage, double faults, forehand winners, backhand winners, volleys during the match, and the like.

(30) Pre-processing agent **116** may be configured to process data retrieved from data store **118**. For example, pre-processing agent **116** may be configured to generate one or more sets of information that may be used to train portions of prediction models **122**.

(31) Tennis module **120** may be configured to generate one or more metrics before a match or within a match. Tennis module **120** may include prediction models **122** and a simulator **124**. Prediction models **122** may be representative of a liner or non-linear model. For example, prediction models **122** may be representative of a random decision forest model. Prediction models **122** may be trained to generate the various predictions both before a match or within a match. For example, prediction models **122** may be trained using a historical match data taken from a plurality of match files **126**. As output, prediction models **122** may generate one or more metrics associated with scoring data at a game-level, a set-level, and/or a match-level.

(32) Exemplary inputs to prediction models **122** may include, but are not limited to, match-state information, match-stats and features, momentum, player one strength, player two strength, player

one style, player two style, court-type, weather conditions, and the like. Match-state information may correspond to current game information (e.g., 0, 15, 30, deuce, advantage, etc.), set information (0-6 or 0-7), match score information (e.g., 0-2 or 0-3), and serve information (e.g., player one or player two).

(33) Match stats and features may correspond to a number of aces, winners, forced errors, unforced errors, player one serve percentage, player two serve percentage, double faults, forehand winners, backhand winners, volleys during the match, and the like.

(34) In some embodiments, momentum may correspond to a change in win-probability. In some embodiments, momentum may correspond to how many of the last X points (e.g., last 10 points) the player (player one or player two) has won.

(35) In some embodiments, player one strength may correspond to a relative player ranking or seeding. In some embodiments, player one strength may be derived from recent detailed player statistics and/or pre-game market odds from a sports book or other crowdsourced method. In some embodiments, player two strength may correspond to a relative player ranking or seeding. In some embodiments, player two strength may be derived from recent detailed player statistics and/or pre-game market odds from a sports book or other crowdsourced method. In some embodiments, player strength data may be derived or calculated from spatial data. For example, player strength data may be derived or calculated from RunningBall data available from STATS Perform, another third party data stream provider, or from tracking obtained by tracking system **102**.

(36) In some embodiments, player one style may be derived from player one statistics. In some embodiments, player one style may be derived from spatial information of player one's behavior (e.g., heat maps). In some embodiments, player one style may be derived using player one/ball tracking data for fine-grained analysis. In some embodiments, player two style may be derived from player two statistics. In some embodiments, player two style may be derived from spatial information of player two's behavior (e.g., heat maps). In some embodiments, player two style may be derived using player two/ball tracking data for fine-grained analysis. In some embodiments, player style data may be derived or calculated from spatial data. For example, player style data may be derived or calculated from RunningBall data available from STATS Perform, another third party data stream provider, or from tracking obtained by tracking system **102**.

(37) In some embodiments, court type may correspond to a playing surface on which the match is occurring (e.g., clay, grass, hard, etc.). In some embodiments, court type may further include information about the state of the playing surface (e.g., court temperature, how worn the grass is, etc.). In some embodiments, weather conditions may correspond to the current weather (e.g., outside temperature, sun location, wind, humidity, etc.).

(38) In some embodiments, inputs to tennis module **120** may be interactive. For example, a user of client device **108** may manually enter in any possible score for prediction models **122** to predict the probabilities of next point, game, set, and/or match via an interactive interface (e.g., widget), chat bot, smart assistant, speech recognizer, or other interactive means.

(39) Exemplary outputs from prediction models **122** may include, but are not limited to: a prediction of what player will win the next point (e.g., 0 or 1), a final score prediction (e.g., multi-class classifier such as {4-0, 4-1, 4-2, 4-3, 0-4, 1-4, 2-4, 3-4}), a final set score prediction (e.g., multi-set classifier such as {6-0, 6-1, 6-2, 6-3, 6-5, 7-5, 7-6, and the reverse}), a final tie break score prediction (e.g., multi-class classifier such as {7-0, 7-1, 7-2, 7-3, 7-4, 7-5, 8-6, and beyond, and reverse}), and/or a final game score prediction (e.g., multi-class classifier such as {2-0, 2-1, 0-2, 1-2, etc.}). In some embodiments, exemplary outputs from prediction models **122** may further include predicted final player statistics (e.g., save percentage, number of aces, number of winners, etc.), predicted serve location or first serve, second serve, “let,” double fault, predicted winner location and winner type (e.g., forehand, backhand, volley, smash, etc.), and rally-count.

(40) In some embodiments, the outputs from prediction models **122** may allow prediction models **122** to generate one or more additional metrics. In some embodiments, prediction models **122** may

generate one or more clutch metrics. For example, looking at key moments during a match, prediction models **122** may identify those points of the match that could yield a greater than 10% (or x %) change in win-probability. To do so, prediction models **122** may leverage a simulator **124**. Simulator **124** may take one or more inputs (e.g., inputs to prediction models **122** and/or outputs from prediction models **122**) to identify these points. Once these points are identified, prediction models **122** may identify those players that perform the best in these pressure situations.

(41) In some embodiments, tennis module **120** may be configured to perform a what-if analysis for breakpoints. For example, using simulator **124**, tennis module **120** may generate a metric that captures the impact on the match probability when a player breaks a serve. For example, simulator **124** may compare current win percentage to the impact of winning the breakpoint and/or the current win percentage to the impact of losing the breakpoint. In some embodiments, such output may take the form of a live graphic.

(42) In some embodiments, tennis module **120** may be configured to generate a momentum metric based on the outputs from prediction models **122**. In some embodiments, momentum may be defined as the current win probability (or set-win-probability) and its change over the last X points (e.g., 10 points).

(43) In some embodiments, tennis module **120** may be configured to generate a player plus/minus based on the outputs from prediction models **122**. For example, based on one or more pre-game match predictions, tennis module **120** may look at the difference between how many points the player is expected to win and how many points the player did win.

(44) In some embodiments, tennis module **120** may be configured to generate a rally excitement index. The rally excitement index may be a ranking from 0 to 10, for example, that qualifies every individual rally in a game or match. Such ranking may be subsequently leveraged by end users for searching for clips of highlights or the automatic generation of highlights. In some embodiments, tennis module **120** may generate such rally excitement index by utilizing one or more of spatial data (e.g., running ball data, rally count information, shot type, importance information (e.g., current score), and the like) and tracking information (e.g., location of individual shots, shot speed, rally count, etc.).

(45) In some embodiments, tennis module **120** may be configured to generate a rally index. A rally index may refer to shot-by-shot updates of the rally win prediction that may be used to tell a story about the rally. Such rally index may be used to generate highlight clips.

(46) In some embodiments, tennis module **120** may be configured to generate a shot location predictor. A shot location predictor may be a prediction of where the next shot will land. In some embodiments, shot location predictor may take the form of a visualization via one or more broadcast graphics that may be overlaid on the video. In some embodiments, the visualization may be used as a post-match clip by highlighting a heat map.

(47) Client device **108** may be in communication with organization computing system **104** via network **105**. Client device **108** may be operated by a user. For example, client device **108** may be a mobile device, a tablet, a desktop computer, or any computing system having the capabilities described herein. Users may include, but are not limited to, individuals such as, for example, subscribers, clients, prospective clients, or customers of an entity associated with organization computing system **104**, such as individuals who have obtained, will obtain, or may obtain a product, service, or consultation from an entity associated with organization computing system **104**.

(48) Client device **108** may include at least application **138**. Application **138** may be representative of a web browser that allows access to a website or a stand-alone application. Client device **108** may access application **138** to access one or more functionalities of organization computing system **104**. Client device **108** may communicate over network **105** to request a webpage, for example, from web client application server **114** of organization computing system **104**. For example, client device **108** may be configured to execute application **138** to access fan engagement functionality

around the various predictions generated by tennis module **120**. In some embodiments, application **138** may take the form of a second screen application or a standalone widget, which may be embedded into existing channels. In some embodiments, application **138** may allow a user to enter interactive inputs for analysis by tennis module **120**.

(49) FIG. 2 is a block diagram illustrating prediction models **122**, according to example embodiments. As shown, prediction models **122** may include point winner model **202**, game winner model **204**, set winner model **206**, and match winner model **208**. In some embodiments, each of point winner model **202**, game winner model **204**, set winner model **206**, and match winner model **208** may take the form of a gradient boosting tree model.

(50) Point winner model **202** may be configured to predict whether a player will win the next point based on various inputs **212**. As shown, inputs **212** may include court type **220** (e.g., grass, clay, hard), pre-match odds **222**, and match state **224** (e.g., current game and set score), in-match statistics **226** (e.g., difference in points won, games won, breaks won in the current game, set, and match, serve percentages, return percentages, etc.). Such inputs **212** may be generated by pre-processing agent **116**. Point winner model **202** may be trained to predict the outcome of the next point based on inputs **212**. For example, the output from point winner model **202** may be a point-win probability **228**, which provides a probability of the player winning the next point.

(51) Game winner model **204** may be configured to predict whether the player will win the current game and/or the next game based on various inputs **214**. As shown, inputs **214** may be similar to inputs **212**. For example, inputs **214** may similarly include court type **220**, pre-match odds **222**, match state **224**, and in-match statistics **226**. However, because game winner model **204** is downstream of point winner model in the chain of models, inputs **214** may also include the output from point winner model **202**, i.e., point-win probability **228**. Such inputs **214** may be generated by pre-processing agent **116**. Game winner model **204** may be trained to predict the outcome of the game based on inputs **214**. For example, the output from game winner model **204** may be a game-win probability **230**, which provides a probability of the player winning the game.

(52) Set winner model **206** may be configured to predict whether the player will win the current set and/or the next set based on various inputs **216**. As shown, inputs **216** may be similar to inputs **214**. For example, inputs **216** may similarly include court type **220**, pre-match odds **222**, match state **224**, and in-match statistics **226**. However, because set winner model **206** is downstream of point winner model **202** and game winner model **204** in the chain of models, inputs **216** may also include the output from point winner model **202**, i.e., point-win probability **228**, and the output from game winner model **204**, i.e., game-win probability **230**. Such inputs **216** may be generated by pre-processing agent **116**. Set winner model **206** may be trained to predict the outcome of the set based on inputs **216**. For example, the output from set winner model **206** may be a set-win probability **232**, which provides a probability of the player winning the set.

(53) Match winner model **208** may be configured to predict whether the player will win the current match and/or the next match based on various inputs **218**. As shown, inputs **218** may be similar to inputs **216**. For example, inputs **218** may similarly include court type **220**, pre-match odds **222**, match state **224**, and in-match statistics **226**. However, because match winner model **208** is downstream of point winner model **202**, game winner model **204**, and set winner model **206** in the chain of models, inputs **218** may also include the output from point winner model **202**, i.e., point-win probability **228**, the output from game winner model **204**, i.e., game-win probability **230**, and the output from set winner model **206**, i.e., set-win probability **232**. Such inputs **218** may be generated by pre-processing agent **116**. Match winner model **208** may be trained to predict the outcome of the match based on inputs **218**. For example, the output from match winner model **208** may be a match-win probability **234**, which provides a probability of the player winning the match.

(54) As shown, as output, prediction models **122** may generate outputs **210**. Outputs **210** may include point-win probability **228**, game-win probability **230**, set-win probability **232**, and match-win probability **234**.

(55) FIG. 3 illustrates an exemplary graphical user interface (GUI) **300**, according to example embodiments. As shown, GUI **300** may provide an exemplary win probability graphic corresponding to a predicted win probability generated by prediction models **122**. The win probability graphic includes a next point win probability graphic **302**, a game win probability graphic **304**, and a match win probability graphic **306**. Further, in some embodiments, the win probability graphic may further include a chart illustrating **308** the match win probability for Kuznetsova over the courts of the match.

(56) FIG. 4 illustrates an exemplary graphical user interface (GUI) **400**, according to example embodiments. As shown, GUI **400** may include a break-point analysis graphic **402**. Break-point analysis graphic **402** is shown overlaying a broadcast video stream of the match. For example, break-point analysis graphic **402** may be displayed in real-time, or near real-time, to the user while the user is watching the match. Break-point analysis graphic **402** may show the impact on the match win probability for the player if he or she wins the next point. As provided above, tennis module **120** may be configured to generate such a metric and break-point analysis graphic **402** representing the metric.

(57) FIG. 5 illustrates an exemplary graphical user interface (GUI) **500**, according to example embodiments. As shown, GUI **500** may include a momentum graphic **502**. Momentum graphic **502** may be a visual representation corresponding to the rally excitement index generated by tennis module **120**. In some embodiments, GUI **500** may further include a highlight list **504**. Highlight list **504** may be automatically generated to include various clips of the game or match that exceed a threshold momentum or rally excitement index threshold.

(58) FIG. 6A illustrates an exemplary graphical user interface (GUI) **600**, according to example embodiments. As shown, GUI **600** may include a rally index graphic **602** overlaying a broadcast video feed of the match. Rally index graphic **602** may be visual representation corresponding to the rally index generated by tennis module **120**.

(59) FIG. 6B illustrates an exemplary graphical user interface (GUI) **650**, according to example embodiments. As shown, GUI **650** may include a rally index graphic **652**. Rally index graphic **652** may be visual representation corresponding to the rally index generated by tennis module **120**. As shown, rally index graphic **652** is overlaid onto the broadcast of the match.

(60) FIG. 7A illustrates an exemplary graphical user interface (GUI) **700**, according to example embodiments. As shown, GUI **700** may include a visual indication **702** corresponding to a shot location prediction of where the next shot will land. Visual indication **702** of the shot location prediction may correspond to the prediction generated by tennis module **120**. As shown, visual indication **702** may be overlaid onto the broadcast of the match.

(61) FIG. 7B illustrates an exemplary graphical user interface (GUI) **750**, according to example embodiments. As shown, GUI **750** may include a visual indication **752** corresponding to a shot location prediction of where the next shot will land. Visual indication **752** of the shot location prediction may correspond to the prediction generated by tennis module **120**. As shown, visual indication **752** may be overlaid onto the broadcast of the match.

(62) FIG. 8 is a flow diagram illustrating a method **800** of generating pre-match and in-match tennis predictions, according to example embodiments. Method **800** may begin at step **802**.

(63) At step **802**, organization computing system **104** may receive one or more match metrics prior to the start of the match. In some embodiments, the one or more match metrics may correspond to historical match metrics for each player.

(64) At step **804**, organization computing system **104** may generate one or more pre-match predictions based on the one or more match metrics received prior to the start of the match. In some embodiments, tennis module **120** may generate the one or more pre-match prediction using prediction models **122**.

(65) At step **806**, organization computing system **104** may receive live match data during the course of the match. Exemplary live match data may include, but is not limited to, match-state

information, match-stats and features, momentum, player one strength, player two strength, player one style, player two style, court-type, weather conditions, and the like.

(66) At step **808**, organization computing system **104** may generate one or more in-match predictions based on the live match data. For example, tennis module **120** may generate one or more in-match predictions using prediction models **122** and/or simulator **124**. Exemplary in-match predictions may include, but are not limited to, a prediction of what player will win the next point (e.g., 0 or 1), a final score prediction (e.g., multi-class classifier such as {4-0, 4-1, 4-2, 4-3, 0-4, 1-4, 2-4, 3-4}), a final set score prediction (e.g., multi-set classifier such as {6-0, 6-1, 6-2, 6-3, 6-5, 8-5, 8-6, and the reverse}), a final tie break score prediction (e.g., multi-class classifier such as {7-0, 8-1, 8-2, 8-3, 8-4, 8-5, 8-6, and beyond, and reverse}), and/or a final game score prediction (e.g., multi-class classifier such as {2-0, 2-1, 0-2, 1-2, etc.}). In some embodiments, exemplary outputs from prediction models **122** may further include predicted final player statistics (e.g., save percentage, number of aces, number of winners, etc.), predicted serve location or first serve, second serve, “let,” double fault, predicted winner location and winner type (e.g., forehand, backhand, volley, smash, etc.), and rally-count. In some embodiments exemplary in-match predictions may further include a breakpoint-analysis, one or more clutch metrics, a momentum analysis, a player plus/minus, and the like.

(67) FIGS. **9A-9B** are exemplary diagrams illustrating match states of a tennis game, according to example embodiments.

(68) For tennis, as those skilled in the art understand, a match typically involves two players playing to the best of three sets. In some competitions, the two players may play to the best of five sets. Each match includes a plurality of sets. Each set includes a plurality of games. Each game includes a plurality of points. When a player wins a game by more than two points, that players has won a game. When a player is the first to win a threshold number of games (e.g., at least 6), that player has won the set. A player wins the match when they win two out of three (or three out of five) sets.

(69) FIG. **9A** illustrates a first state **900** of the tennis game, according to example embodiments. As shown, a player (e.g., Player One) may serve (numeral “**902**”) to a second player (e.g., Player Two). At this point, there are several outcomes that may occur. First, Player One may commit a fault, i.e., an illegal serve. If Player One committed a fault on first serve **904**, then Player One may perform a second serve **906**. If Player One faults again on second serve **906**, then Player One committed what is referred to as a “double fault” and Player One loses the point **912**.

(70) If, however, Player One successfully serves first serve **904** (i.e., did not fault) or second serve **906** (i.e., did not double fault), then there may be several outcomes. In some embodiments, Player One wins a point **910** (e.g., “ace”). In some embodiments, Player Two returns **908** the serve.

(71) FIG. **9B** illustrates a second state **920** of the tennis game, according to example embodiments. In second state **920**, Player Two has successfully returned the shot to Player One. At this point, several outcomes may occur. First, Player Two may return the shot and win a point against Player One. Second, Player Two may return the shot and lose a point against player one (e.g., ball is hit out of bounds). Third, a rally **922** may begin with Player One returning the returned shot to Player Two. As shown, the states may switch between a player shooting (e.g., Server Shot **924**) and a player returning (e.g., Returner Shot **926**) until a scoring event occurs. In other words, rally **922** may continue between Player One serving or hitting the ball to Player Two and Player Two returning the ball to Player One until Player One or Player Two scores a point.

(72) Once a point is scored, the game state may return to first state **900** for a new point to begin.

(73) FIG. **10A** illustrates a system bus architecture of computing system **1000**, according to example embodiments. System **1000** may be representative of at least a portion of organization computing system **104**. One or more components of system **1000** may be in electrical communication with each other using a bus **1005**. System **1000** may include a processing unit (CPU or processor) **1010** and a system bus **1005** that couples various system components including

the system memory **1015**, such as read only memory (ROM) **1020** and random access memory (RAM) **1025**, to processor **1010**. System **1000** may include a cache of high-speed memory connected directly with, in close proximity to, or integrated as part of processor **1010**. System **1000** may copy data from memory **1015** and/or storage device **1030** to cache **1012** for quick access by processor **1010**. In this way, cache **1012** may provide a performance boost that avoids processor **1010** delays while waiting for data. These and other modules may control or be configured to control processor **1010** to perform various actions. Other system memory **1015** may be available for use as well. Memory **1015** may include multiple different types of memory with different performance characteristics. Processor **1010** may include any general purpose processor and a hardware module or software module, such as service **1 1032**, service **2 1034**, and service **3 1036** stored in storage device **1030**, configured to control processor **1010** as well as a special-purpose processor where software instructions are incorporated into the actual processor design. Processor **1010** may essentially be a completely self-contained computing system, containing multiple cores or processors, a bus, memory controller, cache, etc. A multi-core processor may be symmetric or asymmetric.

(74) To enable user interaction with the computing system **1000**, an input device **1045** may represent any number of input mechanisms, such as a microphone for speech, a touch-sensitive screen for gesture or graphical input, keyboard, mouse, motion input, speech and so forth. An output device **1035** may also be one or more of a number of output mechanisms known to those of skill in the art. In some instances, multimodal systems may enable a user to provide multiple types of input to communicate with computing system **1000**. Communications interface **1040** may generally govern and manage the user input and system output. There is no restriction on operating on any particular hardware arrangement and therefore the basic features here may easily be substituted for improved hardware or firmware arrangements as they are developed.

(75) Storage device **1030** may be a non-volatile memory and may be a hard disk or other types of computer readable media which may store data that are accessible by a computer, such as magnetic cassettes, flash memory cards, solid state memory devices, digital versatile disks, cartridges, random access memories (RAMs) **1025**, read only memory (ROM) **1020**, and hybrids thereof.

(76) Storage device **1030** may include services **1032**, **1034**, and **1036** for controlling the processor **1010**. Other hardware or software modules are contemplated. Storage device **1030** may be connected to system bus **1005**. In one aspect, a hardware module that performs a particular function may include the software component stored in a computer-readable medium in connection with the necessary hardware components, such as processor **1010**, bus **1005**, output device **1035** (e.g., display), and so forth, to carry out the function.

(77) FIG. **10B** illustrates a computer system **1050** having a chipset architecture that may represent at least a portion of organization computing system **104**. Computer system **1050** may be an example of computer hardware, software, and firmware that may be used to implement the disclosed technology. System **1050** may include a processor **1055**, representative of any number of physically and/or logically distinct resources capable of executing software, firmware, and hardware configured to perform identified computations. Processor **1055** may communicate with a chipset **1060** that may control input to and output from processor **1055**. In this example, chipset **1060** outputs information to output **1065**, such as a display, and may read and write information to storage device **1070**, which may include magnetic media, and solid state media, for example. Chipset **1060** may also read data from and write data to storage device **1075** (e.g., RAM). A bridge **1080** for interfacing with a variety of user interface components **1085** may be provided for interfacing with chipset **1060**. Such user interface components **1085** may include a keyboard, a microphone, touch detection and processing circuitry, a pointing device, such as a mouse, and so on. In general, inputs to system **1050** may come from any of a variety of sources, machine generated and/or human generated.

(78) Chipset **1060** may also interface with one or more communication interfaces **1090** that may

have different physical interfaces. Such communication interfaces may include interfaces for wired and wireless local area networks, for broadband wireless networks, as well as personal area networks. Some applications of the methods for generating, displaying, and using the GUI disclosed herein may include receiving ordered datasets over the physical interface or be generated by the machine itself by processor **1055** analyzing data stored in storage device **1070** or storage device **1075**. Further, the machine may receive inputs from a user through user interface components **1085** and execute appropriate functions, such as browsing functions by interpreting these inputs using processor **1055**.

(79) It may be appreciated that example systems **1000** and **1050** may have more than one processor **1010** or be part of a group or cluster of computing devices networked together to provide greater processing capability.

(80) While the foregoing is directed to embodiments described herein, other and further embodiments may be devised without departing from the basic scope thereof. For example, aspects of the present disclosure may be implemented in hardware or software or a combination of hardware and software. One embodiment described herein may be implemented as a program product for use with a computer system. The program(s) of the program product define functions of the embodiments (including the methods described herein) and can be contained on a variety of computer-readable storage media. Illustrative computer-readable storage media include, but are not limited to: (i) non-writable storage media (e.g., read-only memory (ROM) devices within a computer, such as CD-ROM disks readably by a CD-ROM drive, flash memory, ROM chips, or any type of solid-state non-volatile memory) on which information is permanently stored; and (ii) writable storage media (e.g., floppy disks within a diskette drive or hard-disk drive or any type of solid state random-access memory) on which alterable information is stored. Such computer-readable storage media, when carrying computer-readable instructions that direct the functions of the disclosed embodiments, are embodiments of the present disclosure.

(81) It will be appreciated to those skilled in the art that the preceding examples are exemplary and not limiting. It is intended that all permutations, enhancements, equivalents, and improvements thereto are apparent to those skilled in the art upon a reading of the specification and a study of the drawings are included within the true spirit and scope of the present disclosure. It is therefore intended that the following appended claims include all such modifications, permutations, and equivalents as fall within the true spirit and scope of these teachings.

Claims

1. A method, comprising: tracking, by a computing system, via at least one calibrated camera and at least one tag, one or more motions of a first player and a second player on a playing surface and one or more objects; based on the tracking, storing, by the computing system, at least one player identity corresponding to the first player and the second player and positional information corresponding to the first player, the second player, and the one or more objects as pre-match data in a data store; receiving, by the computing system, the pre-match data for a match between the first player and the second player from a data store, the pre-match data comprising player strength information for the first player and the second player, player style information for the first player and the second player, a playing surface type, or one or more weather conditions; generating, by the computing system using one or more prediction models, a pre-match prediction based on the pre-match data, wherein the pre-match prediction includes one or more metrics associated with scoring data at a game-level, a set-level, and/or a match level; receiving, by the computing system, in-match data for the match currently in progress, wherein the in-match data comprises one or more of match-state information, match-statistics and features, momentum, the player strength information for the first player and the second player, the player style information for the first player and the second player, the playing surface type, or one or more updated weather conditions; generating, by

the computing system using the one or more prediction models, a live match prediction based on the in-match data and the pre-match prediction; utilizing, by the computing system, a simulator to generate an additional metric based on the live match prediction, wherein the additional metric includes one or more match events that indicate a change in win-probability greater than a threshold; identifying, by the computing system using the one or more prediction models, at least one player that has a best performance during the one or more match events based on the additional metric; and outputting, by the computing system, a visual representation corresponding to the live match prediction and the at least one player on a display.

2. The method of claim 1, wherein generating, by the computing system using the one or more prediction models, the live match prediction comprises: generating one or more of a prediction of what player will win a next point, a final score prediction, a final set score prediction, a final tie break score prediction, a final game score prediction, final player statistics, predicted serve, predicted winner location, predicted winner type, or rally-count.

3. The method of claim 1, further comprising: receiving, by the computing system, input from a user device, wherein the input provides a possible score for the match; and generating, by the computing system, updated predictions based on the input from the user device.

4. The method of claim 1, wherein the player strength information for the first player and the player strength information for the second player are derived from spatial data of the match.

5. The method of claim 1, wherein player style information for the first player and the player style information for the second player are derived from spatial data of the match.

6. The method of claim 1, further comprising: generating, by the computing system, a momentum metric based on the live match prediction, wherein the momentum metric represents a change in current win probability over a set amount of points.

7. The method of claim 1, wherein utilizing, by the computing system, the simulator to generate the additional metric based on the live match prediction further comprises: generating, by the computing system via the simulator, a clutchness metric based on the live match prediction, wherein the clutchness metric is based on points of the match that yield a greater than the threshold.

8. The method of claim 1, further comprising: generating, by the computing system, a plus-minus metric for the first player and the second player based on the live match prediction, wherein the plus-minus metric represents a difference between how many points the first player is expected to win and the second player is expected to win and how many points the first player won and how many points the second player did win.

9. The method of claim 1, wherein the at least one tag includes a tag worn by the first player or the second player or wherein the at least one tag includes an embedded tag in at least one of the one or more objects.

10. A non-transitory computer readable medium comprising one or more sequences of instructions, which, when executed by a processor, causes a computing system to perform operations comprising: tracking, by a computing system, via at least one calibrated camera and at least one tag, one or more motions of a first player and a second player on a playing surface and one or more objects; based on the tracking, storing, by the computing system, at least one player identity corresponding to the first player and the second player and positional information corresponding to the first player, the second player, and the one or more objects as pre-match data in a data store; receiving, by the computing system, the pre-match data for a match between the first player and the second player from a data store, the pre-match data comprising player strength information for the first player and the second player, player style information for the first player and the second player, a playing surface type, or one or more weather conditions; generating, by the computing system using one or more prediction models, a pre-match prediction based on the pre-match data, wherein the pre-match prediction includes one or more metrics associated with scoring data at a game-level, a set-level, and/or a match level; receiving, by the computing system, in-match data for the match currently in progress, wherein the in-match data comprises one or more of match-state

information, match-statistics and features, momentum, the player strength information for the first player and the second player, the player style information for the first player and the second player, the playing surface type, or one or more updated weather conditions; generating, by the computing system using the one or more prediction models, a live match prediction based on the in-match data and the pre-match prediction; utilizing, by the computing system, a simulator to generate an additional metric based on the live match prediction, wherein the additional metric includes one or more match events that indicate a change in win-probability greater than a threshold; identifying, by the computing system using the one or more prediction models, at least one player that has a best performance during the one or more match events based on the additional metric; and outputting, by the computing system, a visual representation corresponding to the live match prediction and the at least one player on a display.

11. The non-transitory computer readable medium of claim 10, wherein generating, by the computing system using the one or more prediction models, the live match prediction comprises: generating one or more of a prediction of what player will win a next point, a final score prediction, a final set score prediction, a final tie break score prediction, a final game score prediction, final player statistics, predicted serve, predicted winner location, predicted winner type, or rally-count.

12. The non-transitory computer readable medium of claim 10, further comprising: receiving, by the computing system, input from a user device, wherein the input provides a possible score for the match; and generating, by the computing system, updated predictions based on the input from the user device.

13. The non-transitory computer readable medium of claim 10, wherein the player strength information for the first player and the player strength information for the second player are derived from spatial data of the match.

14. The non-transitory computer readable medium of claim 10, wherein the player style information for the first player and the player style information for the second player are derived from spatial data of the match.

15. The non-transitory computer readable medium of claim 10, further comprising: generating, by the computing system, a momentum metric based on the live match prediction, wherein the momentum metric represents a change in current win probability over a set amount of points.

16. The non-transitory computer readable medium of claim 10, wherein utilizing, by the computing system, the simulator to generate the additional metric based on the live match prediction further comprises: generating, by the computing system via the simulator, a clutchness metric based on the live match prediction, wherein the clutchness metric is based on points of the match that yield a greater than the threshold.

17. The non-transitory computer readable medium of claim 10, further comprising: generating, by the computing system, a plus-minus metric for the first player and the second player based on the live match prediction, wherein the plus-minus metric represents a difference between how many points the first player is expected to win and how many points the second player is expected to win and how many points the first player won and how many points the second player did win.

18. A system comprising: a processor; and a memory having programming instructions stored thereon, which, when executed by the processor, causes the system to perform operations comprising: tracking, via at least one calibrated camera and at least one tag, one or more motions of a first player and a second player on a playing surface and one or more objects; based on the tracking, storing at least one player identity corresponding to the first player and the second player and positional information corresponding to the first player, the second player, and the one or more objects as pre-match data in a data store; receiving the pre-match data for a match between the first player and the second player from a data store, the pre-match data comprising player strength information for the first player and the second player, player style information for the first player and the second player, a playing surface type, or one or more weather conditions; generating, using one or more prediction models, a pre-match prediction based on the pre-match data, wherein the

pre-match prediction includes one or more metrics associated with scoring data at a game-level, a set-level, and/or a match level; receiving in-match data for the match currently in progress, wherein the in-match data comprises one or more of match-state information, match-statistics and features, momentum, the player strength information for the first player and the second player, the player style information for the first player and the second player, the playing surface type, or one or more updated weather conditions; generating, using the one or more prediction models, a live match prediction based on the in-match data and the pre-match prediction; and utilizing a simulator to generate an additional metric based on the live match prediction, wherein the additional metric includes one or more match events that indicate a change in win-probability greater than a threshold; identifying, using the one or more prediction models, at least one player that has a best performance during the one or more match events based on the additional metric; and outputting, by the computing system, a visual representation corresponding to the live match prediction and the at least one player on a display.

19. The system of claim 18, wherein the operations further comprise: generating a momentum metric based on the live match prediction, wherein the momentum metric represents a change in current win probability over a set amount of points.

20. The system of claim 18, wherein utilizing the simulator to generate the additional metric based on the live match prediction further comprises: generating, via the simulator, a clutchness metric based on the live match prediction, wherein the clutchness metric is based on points of the match that yield a greater than the threshold.
